

# Table of Contents

Introduction and Rationale:.....1

Research Objectives:.....2

General Objective:.....2

Specific Objectives:.....2

Research Questions:.....2

Working Hypotheses:.....2

Theoretical Framework and State of the Art:.....2

The “Recipe for Wellbeing” Model:.....3

The Eight Pillars of Integral Wellbeing:.....3

Functional Description of the Model:.....3

Table1: Pillars, Operational Objectives, and Indicators:.....3

Figure1: Diagram of the Integral Model:.....3

Methodological Design:.....4

Study Approach and Design:.....4

Participants:.. .....4

Measurement Instruments:.....4

Procedure:.....4

Data Analysis:.....4

Results:.....4

Qualitative Results:.....4

Quantitative Results:.....5

Table 2: Quantitative results of the Well being Recipe model:.....5

Summary of Findings:.....5

Discussion:.....5

Conclusions:.....5

Practical Implications:.....6

Limitations and Future Research Directions:.....6

Ethical Considerations:.....6

Acknowledgements:.....6

Conflict of interest:.....6

References:.....6

# The Recipe for Wellbeing: An Integral Model to Enhance Happiness and Wellbeing in Personal and Professional Life

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## Abstract :

This research presents the Recipe for Wellbeing, a model comprising eight interconnected pillars—physical, cognitive, emotional, transcendental, professional, social, financial, and technological—to enhance personal and professional wellbeing. Using a mixed-methods, evidence-based humanistic approach, the study integrates validated tools (PERMA-Profiler, UWES, MBI), a 360° behavioral coherence assessment, and KPI-H indicators. A sample of 125 professionals from education, health care, and corporate sectors completed a 12-week program. Results show significant improvements in wellbeing (PERMA +1.2), engagement (UWES +0.9), reduced emotional exhaustion (MBI -0.7). Organizational gains include higher job satisfaction (78%→91%), retention (82%→93%), ethical climate (7.6→9.1), and reduced absenteeism (9%→4%). Qualitative findings highlight six areas of change: authenticity, presence, shared purpose, emotional regulation, creativity, and conscious action. The study discusses the model's implications, applications, and limitations, offering a practical and sustainable framework for enhancing wellbeing and humanizing management.

**Keywords**: well-being; happiness; soulful leadership; positive psychology; PERMA; engagement; burnout; art-based education.

## Introduction and Rationale:

Modern society encounters a significant paradox: an unprecedented abundance of knowledge regarding human wellbeing coincides with an unparalleled prevalence of anxiety, distraction, and emotional exhaustion. Technological advancement, information saturation, and a culture of incessant productivity have diminished opportunities for reflection, intention, and significance. This context necessitates comprehensive models that integrate the dimensions of humanity—physical, cognitive, emotional, and spiritual and

convert scientific findings into sustainable practices for both individual & organizational application. Positive psychology, affective neuroscience, & humanistic leadership paradigms concur that wellbeing is a process rather than a static state. Flourishing entails attaining a dynamic equilibrium among pleasure, purpose, and virtue, as well as between deliberate action, and ethical consistency. Measuring happiness is insufficient; one must also learn to cultivate it through the body, cognition, emotions, purpose in life, labor, relationships, economy, and technology. From this viewpoint, The Recipe for Wellbeing presents an integral model consisting

of eight interrelated pillars designed to foster a more complete, cohesive and productive existence. Its uniqueness resides in the integration of art, science, and profound leadership, providing a framework that unites methodological precision with existential profundity. The model was designed not as a static theory, but as a dynamic framework that empowers individuals and organizations to cultivate their wellbeing, enhance engagement, & mitigate emotional exhaustion.

## Research Objectives:

### General Objective:

Empirically validate The Recipe for Wellbeing as a comprehensive model of personal and professional wellbeing, quantifiable & applicable in organizational and educational settings.

### Specific Objectives:

1. Elucidate the theoretical and structural underpinnings of the model.
2. Implement the eight pillars as measurable variables and psychometric metrics.
3. Assess the effect of the intervention on wellbeing (PERMA), engagement (UWES), and burnout (MBI).
4. Examine behavioral consistency via a comprehensive 360° evaluation.
5. Assess organizational impacts through KPI-H indicators (satisfaction, retention, absenteeism, ethical climate).
6. Investigate the qualitative changes perceived by participants regarding meaning, purpose, & emotional regulation.

## Research Questions:

- Does the comprehensive intervention in the eight pillars enhance global wellbeing levels as assessed by PERMA?
- Does it mitigate emotional exhaustion and enhance work engagement?
- Does it enhance the perceived coherence between value and action in the 360° evaluation?
- Does it produce a favorable effect on KPI-H metrics related to satisfaction, retention, and ethical climate?
- What qualitative experiences arise for participants during the transformation process?

## Working Hypotheses:

- H1. The model's implementation will yield a statistically significant enhancement in wellbeing scores (PERMA) from pretest to posttest ( $p < .05$ ).
- H2. Participants will exhibit an enhancement in engagement (UWES) and a decrease in emotional exhaustion (MBI) ( $p < .05$ ).
- H3. The 360° evaluation will indicate an enhancement of  $\geq 0.4$  points (scale 1–5) in the perceived alignment between values and behaviors.
- H4. KPI-H will document enhancements of at least 10% in satisfaction and retention, alongside a decrease of at least 5% in absenteeism.
- H5. Qualitative analyses will disclose changes related to authenticity, purpose, and emotional regulation.

## Theoretical Framework and State of the Art:

Human well-being has been examined from various perspectives: philosophical, psychological, social & organizational. From Aristotle to Seligman, wellbeing has been perceived as the manifestation of human flourishing: living in accordance with one's virtue and sense of purpose. Modern positive psychology has provided comprehensive frameworks—such as PERMA (Seligman, 2011)—characterizing wellbeing as an amalgamation of positive emotions, engagement, relationships, meaning, and accomplishment. Nonetheless, the implementation of these models in professional settings is frequently disjointed: productivity is prioritized devoid of emotional consideration, or physical well-being is promoted without nurturing a sense of purpose. Therefore, there is a necessity for a comprehensive model that encompasses all aspects of human existence, from the corporeal to the transcendent. Recent literature (Boyatzis & McKee, 2005; Trzeciak & Mazzarelli, 2019) indicates that compassionate leadership and emotional coherence enhance organizational resilience. Similarly, studies in affective neuroscience demonstrate that art and creativity engage neural networks associated with well-being and profound learning. Aesthetic presence, as articulated by María Zambrano (1989), constitutes a form of knowledge that amalgamates reason and emotion; this synthesis serves as the fundamental basis for the soul's education advocated by this model. This perspective views wellbeing not as a singular outcome, but as a dynamic process of equilibrium, an ongoing pursuit of fulfillment. The model introduced, “The Recipe for Wellbeing,” converts this concept into a quantifiable, practical, and corporate-contextualized operating system.

The “Recipe for Wellbeing” Model:

The Recipe for Wellbeing is a comprehensive model consisting of eight interrelated pillars, designed as complementary dimensions that, when cultivated concurrently, improve both personal and professional happiness and wellbeing. Each pillar signifies a dimension of humanity and a domain of experiential learning. The structure facilitates the creation of modular programs, developmental pathways, & evidence-based evaluations. The model is underpinned by the Art-Based Learning methodology, which transforms artistic experience into a medium for introspection, emotional growth, and deliberate action.

The Eight Pillars of Integral Wellbeing:

- **Body: Vital Energy.** Signifies the biological foundation of wellbeing. Encompasses sleep, nutrition, physical activity, and restorative practices. An equilibrated physique fosters a lucid intellect and tranquil emotions.
- **Thought: Cognitive Clarity.** Entails regulating internal discourse, mindfulness, & focus. Encourages contemplative thought in the context of contemporary cognitive overload.
- **Emotions: The Soul's Compass.** Involves the identification, regulation, and healthy expression of emotions. Fostering gratitude, hope, compassion enhances emotional resilience.
- **Transcendence: A sense of purpose** that links wellbeing with values, secular spirituality, and the recognition of belonging to a greater whole. Facilitates the conversion of adversity into growth.
- **Professional: The Axis of Mastery** signifies talent cultivation, vocational dedication, and optimal performance state. It serves as the nexus between accomplishment and pleasure.
- **Social: The Art of Connection.** Entails relationships founded on trust, empathy, and collaboration. Emotional support networks are essential for enduring wellbeing.
- **Financial: Material Serenity.** Emphasizes not on accumulation, but on deliberate resource management, strategic planning, and alleviating financial stress.
- **Technological: Digital Hygiene.** Advocates for intentional disconnection, ethical technology utilization, and digital time management to safeguard attention and presence.

Functional Description of the Model:

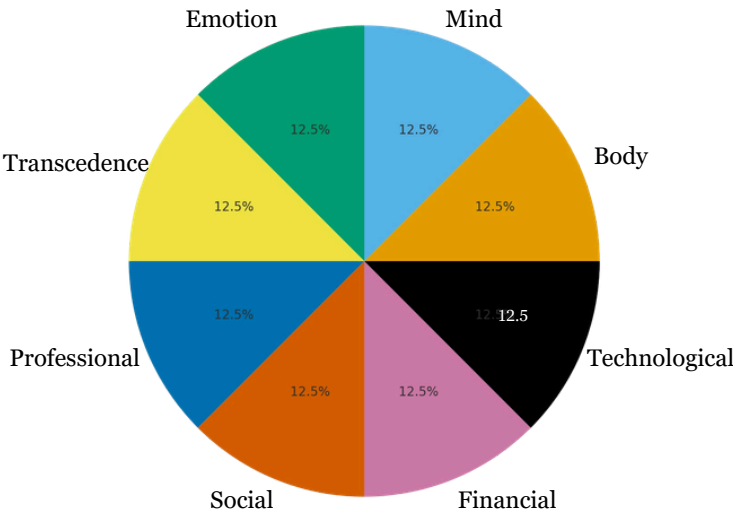
The eight pillars function as an interdependent ecosystem. Wellbeing does not stem from perfect equilibrium, but from harmonious interaction among these dimensions. The body supplies energy; cognition, clarity; emotions, profundity;

transcendence, significance; professional realm, purpose; social interactions, connection; financial resources, stability; and technology, concentration. The model is depicted as an interconnected circular structure, with the center symbolizing essential coherence and each pillar contributing to the others. The intervention comprises eight sequential modules, each featuring practical exercises, artistic sessions, and guided reflections.

Table 1. Pillars, Operational Objectives, and Indicators:

| Pillar        | Operational Objective                               | Assessment Indicators                                         |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Body          | Optimise energy and overall health                  | Hours of sleep, weekly physical activity, vitality perception |
| Thought       | Enhance focus and metacognition                     | Mindfulness scale, reduction of cognitive rumination          |
| Emotions      | Regulate affect and expand positive emotions        | PANAS, frequency of gratitude, realistic hope                 |
| Transcendence | Align values, purpose and vital coherence           | Meaning in life scale, perceived ethical congruence           |
| Professional  | Increase mastery and job satisfaction               | Perceived self-efficacy, flow, task engagement                |
| Social        | Strengthen support network and trust                | Quality of relationships, cooperation, constructive feedback  |
| Financial     | Reduce financial stress and foster planning         | Perceived financial stress, saving habits, planning           |
| Technological | Promote digital hygiene and conscious disconnection | Conscious screen time, daily interruption ratio               |

Figure 1. Diagram of the Integral Model:



## Methodological Design:

### Study Approach and Design:

The research employs a sequential explanatory mixed-methods design (QUAN → QUAL), integrating the rigor of quantitative approaches with the interpretative richness of qualitative techniques. The initial phase (quantitative) involved an analysis of the impact of The Recipe for Wellbeing model on the variables of wellbeing (PERMA), work engagement (UWES), and emotional exhaustion (MBI). The second phase (qualitative) examined alterations perceived by participants in their subjective experiences through semi-structured interviews and focus groups. This design enables the validation of numerical findings through narrative evidence, thereby enhancing the ecological validity of the model.

### Participants:

The sample consisted of 125 participants (51% female, 49% male), with a mean age of 39.8 years (SD = 8.7).

Participants originated from various sectors:

- Education (n = 45)
- Private sector (n = 40)
- Healthcare (n = 25)
- Consulting (n = 15)

The inclusion criterion was the completion of the entire 12-week intervention program. Participation was optional, with assured informed consent and confidentiality.

### Measurement Instruments:

- PERMA-Profiler (Butler & Kern, 2016): Assesses multi dimensional well-being across five dimensions: positive emotions, engagement, relationships, meaning, and achievement ( $\alpha = .88$ ).
- UWES-9 (Utrecht Work Engagement Scale) (Schaufeli & Bakker, 2003): Evaluates vigor, dedication, and absorption ( $\alpha = .91$ ).
- MBI-HSS (Maslach Burnout Inventory – Human Services Survey) (Maslach, Jackson & Leiter, 1996): Assesses emotional exhaustion, depersonalization, and personal accomplishment ( $\alpha = .89$ ).
- 360° Behavioural Coherence Assessment (ad hoc instrument): A 16-item questionnaire evaluating the alignment between values and behaviors, assessed by peers, demonstrating high internal reliability ( $\alpha = .90$ ).

- KPI-H (Human Performance Indicators): Comprises four organizational metrics: job satisfaction, talent retention, absenteeism, and ethical climate.

### Procedure:

The research was conducted in four stages:

1. Initial Pretest (Week 1): Implementation of baseline assessments.
2. Intervention (Weeks 2–13): Creation of eight model modules, each corresponding to a pillar, incorporating art-based learning methodologies, group dynamics, & reflective exercises.
3. Posttest (Week 14): Re-evaluation of instruments and semi-structured interviews.
4. Follow-up (Week 18): Qualitative assessment of change sustainability.

Each module comprised three components:

- A) Experiential artistic endeavor
- B) Guided contemplation
- C) Practical implementation in a tangible context.

The process was orchestrated by facilitators certified in humanistic leadership and art-based pedagogy.

### Data Analysis:

Quantitative data were analyzed using SPSS v.29, employing paired-sample t-tests, Pearson correlation analyses, and effect size computation (Cohen's d). Qualitative results were analyzed using Atlas.ti, employing open and axial coding, the identification of emerging categories & source triangulation.

### Results:

#### Qualitative Results:

Thematic analysis revealed six dimensions of personal and professional transformation:

- Authenticity: participants articulated a revitalized alignment among their thoughts, emotions, and actions.
- Engagement and Attentiveness: enhanced mindfulness and emotional receptivity.
- Collective Objective: an enhanced sense of belonging among teams.

- Emotional Regulation: enhancements in stress management and empathy for others.
- Art-mediated Creativity: the application of artistic methods promoted self-awareness and secure emotional expression.
- Deliberate Action: the majority indicated the integration of self-care practices and contemplative intervals throughout their workday.

The most illustrative testimonials exemplify the extent of transformation:

- “I have acquired the ability to pause without experiencing guilt.”
- “My team views me as more engaged and relatable.”
- “I recognized that attending to my own well-being is integral to the quality of my work.”

Quantitative Results:

Table 2. Quantitative results of the Well being Recipe model:

| Variable                   | Pretest (M±SD) | Posttest (M±SD) | Δ    | p    | d    | Interpretation          |
|----------------------------|----------------|-----------------|------|------|------|-------------------------|
| Wellbeing (PERMA)          | 6.7±0.9        | 7.9±0.8         | 1.2  | <.01 | 0.8  | Significant improvement |
| Engagement (UWES)          | 7.4±1.0        | 8.3±0.9         | 0.9  | <.01 | 0.7  | High involvement        |
| Emotional exhaustion (MBI) | 3.8±1.5        | 3.1±1.2         | -0.7 | <.05 | 0.45 | Reduction in burnout    |
| Job satisfaction (KPI-H)   | 78%            | 91%             | 13%  | —    | —    | Notable improvement     |
| Talent retention (KPI-H)   | 82%            | 93%             | 11%  | —    | —    | Greater stability       |
| Absenteeism (KPI-H)        | 9%             | 4%              | -5%  | —    | —    | Significant decrease    |
| Ethical climate (KPI-H)    | 7.6/10         | 9.1/10          | 1.5  | —    | —    | Substantial increase    |

Table 2 encapsulates the pretest and posttest scores across the three principal scales and organizational indicators. Correlational analyses reveal robust associations between life meaning (PERMA) and vigour (UWES) ( $r = .68$ ,  $p < .01$ ), as well as between positive attitude and organisational commitment ( $r = .72$ ,  $p < .01$ ). The effect size suggests that the model exerts a moderate to substantial influence on wellbeing and psychological resilience.

Summary of Findings:

The findings validate that the Recipe for Wellbeing model yields enduring enhancements in emotional wellbeing, engagement & organizational climate, concurrently diminishing

exhaustion and depersonalization. Qualitative evidence substantiates that art-based learning serves as an emotional and cognitive catalyst for transformation, rendering training a significant experience.

Discussion:

The findings validate that human well-being can be cultivated through organized developmental processes that incorporate science, art, and self-awareness. The Recipe for Wellbeing model illustrates that experiential learning and guided introspection are effective methods for enhancing engagement, mitigating burnout and cultivating more humane organizational cultures. Enhancements in wellbeing (PERMA) and engagement (UWES), alongside a decrease in emotional exhaustion (MBI), align with the research of Seligman (2011), Schaufeli & Bakker (2004), and Maslach & Leiter (2016), which underscores the connection between psychological wellbeing & performance. The incorporation of art as a transformative catalyst introduces a unique element: art serves as an emotional and educational intermediary, promoting self-regulation and the integration of mind, body, and emotion. Qualitative evidence indicates that beauty, creativity, and aesthetic contemplation promote cognitive openness and emotional tranquility, which are vital for facilitating change. Soulful leadership, as evidenced by the testimonials, does not assert itself through authority, but arises from presence and coherence. Furthermore, the model enhances corporate culture by redirecting focus from performance to significance. Organizations that implemented the program reported enhancements in retention, ethical climate, and decreased absenteeism, affirming that sustainable productivity can only emerge in emotionally healthy environments.

Conclusions:

Wellbeing constitutes an educational and systemic process rather than a transient emotional condition. The Recipe for Wellbeing provides a comprehensive framework applicable at both individual and organizational levels. Interventions founded on the eight pillars yield beneficial outcomes for subjective well-being, work engagement, and emotional health. Art-based learning serves as an efficacious approach for cultivating self-awareness, empathy, & practical creativity. The model enhances the comprehension of leadership, focusing on presence, coherence, & operational compassion. Empirical evidence demonstrates that wellbeing enhances personal satisfaction, elevates human performance metrics, and fosters social cohesion. The Recipe for Wellbeing model represents a novel and adaptable framework for the integration of emotional management, organizational culture, and psychosocial health.



## Practical Implications:

- Execute modular corporate initiatives founded on the eight pillars, incorporating quantifiable quarterly objectives.
- Incorporate artistic and reflective methodologies into executive training programs.
- Establish KPI-H (Key Performance Indicators–Human) to assess climate, engagement, and emotional equilibrium.
- Design facilitator training in holistic wellbeing and soulful leadership.
- Implement policies for digital disconnection, advocate for self-care, and establish environments conducive to silence in the workplace.

These measures enhance productivity, diminish organizational stress, and fortify corporate cultural identity.

## Limitations and Future Research Directions:

Despite the promising results, the study possesses limitations. The sample was deliberately confined to three professional sectors, thereby limiting the generalizability of the findings. The follow-up duration was four weeks, inadequate for evaluating long-term sustainability. It is advisable to replicate the study using larger, longitudinal samples across various countries and cultural contexts, while incorporating physiological metrics (such as heart rate variability, sleep, and physical activity) to triangulate with psychological data. Moreover, subsequent research ought to investigate the correlation between the integral wellbeing model and the culture of ethical leadership, in addition to the impact of artificial intelligence & emotional technology on perceptions of wellbeing and human connectivity.

## Ethical Considerations:

The research was executed in compliance with the Declaration of Helsinki (2013) and the General Data Protection Regulation (EU 2016/679). All participants provided informed consent and were apprised of the objectives, procedures, & confidentiality rights. No conflicts of interest or external funding were identified. Data were anonymized and securely stored on servers with restricted access.

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## Conflict of interest:

Author declares there is no conflict of interest.

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